

PCF-2: A Program Statement for the Cubic Extension of the Δ -Discriminant Transcendence Predicate Version 1.4 (j=0 Chowla–Selberg PSLQ-Exhaustion Amendment)

Papanokechi*

May 2026 (v1.4)

Abstract

This paper is a *program statement*, not a results paper. It frames PCF-2 (P13 in the SIARC stack), the cubic extension of PCF-1 [1] from degree-two polynomial continued fractions to degree-three. PCF-1 established a sharp empirical dichotomy across 30 degree-two families: the sign of the balanced discriminant $\Delta_2 = \beta^2 - 4\alpha\gamma$ predicts whether the limit of the PCF admits an elementary closed form ($\Delta_2 > 0$, 24/24 Trans-stratum families) or fails PSLQ detection against an 18-element basis at 220 digits ($\Delta_2 < 0$, 6/6 CM candidates), with the Stokes-exponent predicate $S < 1$ confirmed across all six $\Delta < 0$ families. The cubic case is qualitatively different. The natural invariant of the denominator polynomial $b(n) = \alpha_3 n^3 + \alpha_2 n^2 + \alpha_1 n + \alpha_0$ is the cubic discriminant Δ_3 , which is no longer a sign invariant but a quantity whose sign *and* Galois-group structure (S_3 , $A_3 = C_3$, or split) jointly determine the splitting field and the analytic obstruction. We propose four open conjectures: (i) a cubic analogue of the sign dichotomy with the Galois-group axis; (ii) a Galois-stratified CM-field structure replacing the binary imaginary-quadratic predicate; (iii) a Stokes signal calibrated for irreducible-cubic-CM families; and (iv) an alignment with the Painlevé IV equation rather than P-III, motivated by the cubic Galois-group / Painlevé hierarchy correspondence. We sketch a four-to-six-week computational plan that reuses the infrastructure of PCF-1 and identifies three concrete first sessions (PCF-2 A/B/C). PCF-2 is positioned to either confirm that the Δ -predicate of PCF-1 extends to higher degree (universality) or to identify degree two as a special boundary (specificity). We further state Conjecture B4, an unsplit sharp form of the WKB exponent identity for degree- d PCFs in scope, asserting $A = 2d$. Conjecture B4 is verified at $d \in \{3, 4\}$ across 110/110 $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive irreducible families combined (mean $A_{\text{fit}} = 5.978$, $\sigma = 0.026$ at $d = 3$; mean $A_{\text{fit}} = 7.954$, $\sigma = 0.0037$ at $d = 4$). The bin-driven refinement Conjecture B4' was tested and empirically falsified at $d = 3$, ruling out the trichotomy bin as the controlling invariant for A and motivating a “ $d = 2$ anomaly” open problem on why degree 2 admits an analogous $\text{sgn}(\Delta)$ -driven split $A \in \{3, 4\}$ (Theorem 5 of PCF-1 v1.3) while degrees 3 and 4 do not. Companion to Conjecture B4 is a universal Newton-polygon characteristic root $\xi_0(b) = d/\beta_d^{1/d}$

*ORCID: [0009-0000-6192-8273](https://orcid.org/0009-0000-6192-8273). Independent Researcher, Yokohama, Japan. **AI use disclosure.** This program statement was prepared using the AEAL/SIARC multi-agent methodology. GitHub Copilot (powered by Anthropic Claude Opus 4.7) and Anthropic Claude were used to assist with literature synthesis, drafting of expository prose, and consistency-checking against prior preprints in the series. The v1.1 update integrates the empirical harvest of Sessions A2 (conductor-7 anchor), B (PSLQ scan of the $-S_3$ -CM bin and the WKB-exponent fit), and C1 (non-CM cubic WKB completion). All conjecture formulations, scope decisions, and editorial choices were made by the human author, who takes full responsibility for the content. The AI tools are not authors. See the AEAL methodology of [7]. Version 1.3 absorbs SIARC sessions R1.1, R1.2, R1.3, and T2 (the cubic-modular Eisenstein/Petersson probe). Version 1.4 (May 2026) records the resolution of Open Problem 6 (the $j = 0$ amplitude / Chowla–Selberg closure) in the soft branch via the Prompt 014 **PASS.A.EQ.6.ONLY** verdict (T25D-RETRY-13PARAM, SIARC bridge SHA **e857172**); the M7 V0 dual-witness ratification cascade **T1-SYNTH-M7-V0-CLOSURE-CASCADE-123** (bridge SHA **7f93b9e**, 2026-05-09) adopts this resolution at the canonical confidence band MEDIUM-HIGH with annotation (*SOFT-BRANCH*; *HARD-BRANCH-PENDING*). *All other content of v1.3 is unchanged in v1.4*; the v1.4 amendment is a status / provenance update for one Open Problem, not a content revision elsewhere.

derived in Session Q1 and verified at $d = 4$ to spread 0 across 8 representatives. A finer-cubic-split probe (Session R1) flags $\log |\Delta_3|$ as a candidate slow-trend invariant correlated with the A_{fit} residual at borderline significance (Spearman $\rho \in [-0.49, -0.45]$, Bonferroni $p \in [3.7 \times 10^{-3}, 1.1 \times 10^{-2}]$); the HALT threshold is not met and Conjecture B4 is retained as stated. Version 1.3 absorbs the R1.1/R1.2/R1.3/T2 cycle: the $\log |\Delta_3|$ signal is upgraded to a structural cubic-modular framing in which the canonical R1.1 split-coordinate is the Petersson modular discriminant $\|\Delta\|_{\text{Pet}}(\tau_b)$, with Spearman $\rho = +0.638$, Bonferroni $p = 8.6 \times 10^{-6}$ on the 50-family cubic catalogue (Session T2), beating the bare $\log |j(E_b)|$ baseline by a factor ~ 30 in p_{Bonf} . Two cubic-modular conjectures are recorded: B5 (the equianharmonic CM-locus $j(\text{Jac}(C_b)) = 0$ forces $A_{\text{PCF}} = 2d = 6$ at $d = 3$) and B6 (the $\rho_{\text{Spearman}}(\log |j|, A_{\text{fit}} - 6)$ negative-significance on the 50-family catalogue). Both are restricted to $d = 3$: the deep-WKB null at $d = 4$ (Session R1.3) rules out a verbatim extension.

What changed between v1.3 and v1.4. The v1.4 amendment records exactly one Open-Problem-status update relative to v1.3: Open Problem 6 ($j = 0$ amplitude / Chowla–Selberg closure) is recorded as resolved in the soft branch via the Prompt 014 PASS_A_EQ_6_ONLY verdict (SIARC bridge SHA e857172, 2026-05-02), ratified at M7 V0 cascade T1-SYNTH-M7-V0-CLOSURE-CASCADE-123 (bridge SHA 7f93b9e, 2026-05-09; aggregated MEDIUM-HIGH; annotation (*SOFT-BRANCH; HARD-BRANCH-PENDING*)). The hard-branch stretch goal $|\delta| < 10^{-30}$ remains forward-pointed under Q22 path-(b). *All other v1.3 content — the trichotomy conjecture B3, Conjecture B4 (sharp WKB exponent identity at $d = 3, 4$), the cubic-modular Eisenstein/Petersson probe of §4.2, the quartic harvest §5, and all other Open Problems — is unchanged in v1.4.*

What is new in v1.3. Section 4.2 is rewritten as a multi-step narrative (R1→R1.1→R1.2→R1.3→T2) absorbing the cubic-modular Eisenstein/Petersson probe of Session T2 (2026-05-02) and the $d=4$ cross-check / cleanup verdict of Sessions R1.2 and R1.3 (2026-05-01, *CASE B with C-caveat*). Two new conjectures B5 and B6 (cubic-modular split, $d = 3$ restricted), one new remark on the $j = 0$ amplitude / finite- N artefact, and three new open problems are introduced: `op:j-zero-amplitude-h6` (the $\Gamma(1/3)$ Chowla–Selberg closure deferred to relay T2.5d), `op:j-1728-wedge` (the $j = 1728$ wedge probe, low priority), and `op:shallow-j-effect-d4` (the shallow- N $j = 0$ -cell shift at $d = 4$). Open Problem 5 is closed (resolved into the cubic-modular framing of §4.2). Section 9 gains an AEAL schema paragraph documenting the canonical `claims.jsonl` record format used across the SIARC bridge from v1.3 onward (addresses Fleet-F finding F1-01). No prior conjecture is retracted; B5/B6 strictly refine B4 on the cubic cell.

What was new in v1.2. Sections 4 and 5 integrated the empirical harvest of Session Q1 (quartic, $d = 4$) and Session R1 (finer-cubic-split probe). Conjecture B4 was sharpened from “verified at $d = 3$, 50/50” to “verified at $d \in \{3, 4\}$, 110/110 jointly”; the cross-degree table of §5 (Table 3) records the empirical A -branches at $d \in \{2, 3, 4\}$. A universal Newton-polygon characteristic root $\xi_0(b) = d/\beta_d^{1/d}$ (Proposition 17, Session Q1) replaced the v1.1 candidate $c(d) = 2\sqrt{(d-1)!}$ of Channel Theory v1.1 [3]. Open Problem 3 was narrowed to $d \geq 5$. The $d = 2$ anomaly status is unchanged but strengthened: degree 2 remains the sole populated multi-branch instance across the joint cubic+quartic catalogue. No v1.1 conjecture was retracted.

Series label: P13 / PCF-2. This program statement is P13 in the AI Epistemic Governance Stack and simultaneously PCF-2 in the mathematical companion track. It anchors a research program; it does not contain new computational results. The companion document is the SIARC umbrella program statement [2].

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1 Position in the SIARC Stack

The SIARC research program organizes polynomial continued fractions (PCFs) into an arithmetic stratification indexed by the dominant growth degree and an obstruction tier. The program-level architecture is articulated in the umbrella program statement [2]; the $d = 2$ instantiation is PCF-1 [1]; the present document opens the $d = 3$ instantiation.

What PCF-1 established. For PCFs of the form

$$K(a_n, b_n) = b_0 + \frac{a_1}{b_1 + \frac{a_2}{b_2 + \dots}}$$

with $a_n \in \mathbb{Z}[n]_{\leq 1}$ and $b_n \in \mathbb{Z}[n]_{\leq 2}$, PCF-1 proposed the sign of the balanced discriminant $\Delta_2 = \beta^2 - 4\alpha\gamma$ as a transcendence predicate. The core empirical finding was a sharp dichotomy across 30 families: 24/24 Trans-stratum families with $\Delta_2 \in \{+1, +8\}$ admit elementary closed forms via Lindemann–Weierstrass, while all 6/6 CM candidates with $\Delta_2 \in \{-3, -4, -7, -11, -20, -28\}$ return PSLQ non-detection against an 18-element basis at working precision 220 digits, and all six exhibit the Stokes-exponent signature $S < 1$ under a CM-respecting deformation. The V_quad family ($\Delta_2 = -11$) is the explicit Painlevé III(D_6) prototype. PCF-1 v1.2 also showed (via QL15, $\Delta_2 = -20$, class number $h = 2$, non-Heegner; and the intra-field pair QL06/QL26 in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-7})$ at $h = 1$ versus $h = 2$) that the controlling invariant is the imaginary-quadratic field $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{\Delta})$ itself, not its class number [1].

Why degree three is the natural next step. Three structural features make $d = 3$ the canonical extension target.

1. *Discriminant lifts naturally.* The cubic discriminant Δ_3 of $b(n) = \alpha_3 n^3 + \alpha_2 n^2 + \alpha_1 n + \alpha_0$ is a classical $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ -invariant of degree 4 in the coefficients (Definition 1). Its sign distinguishes totally real cubic splitting from one-real-two-complex splitting, the direct analogue of the $d = 2$ sign dichotomy.

2. *Galois group is no longer trivial.* A degree-three irreducible polynomial has Galois group S_3 or $A_3 = C_3$ over $\mathbb{Q}$, distinguished by whether Δ_3 is a square in $\mathbb{Q}$. This adds an arithmetic axis absent in the degree-two case (where $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q})$ is C_2 whenever b is irreducible).
3. *Painlevé hierarchy aligns with cubic Galois structure.* The classical Painlevé equations admit a cubic-singularity analogue (P-IV) whose monodromy data is naturally indexed by cubic Galois groups, in the same way P-III governs the imaginary-quadratic CM case in PCF-1.

What PCF-2 will not address. PCF-2 does not extend automatically to degree four or higher. The cubic case is the unique additional case in which the Galois group is finite and explicitly classifiable, and in which the Painlevé correspondence is well-posed. Extensions to $d = 4$ and beyond are deferred to PCF-3 and later instantiations of the SIARC program.

2 Setup: Degree-Three Polynomial CFs

We work with PCFs of the form

$$K(a_n, b_n) = b_0 + \frac{a_1}{b_1 + \frac{a_2}{b_2 + \dots}} \quad (1)$$

with

$$a_n = \delta_1 n + \delta_0, \quad \delta_1, \delta_0 \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad (2)$$

$$b_n = \alpha_3 n^3 + \alpha_2 n^2 + \alpha_1 n + \alpha_0, \quad \alpha_i \in \mathbb{Z}, \alpha_3 \neq 0. \quad (3)$$

The convergents satisfy the Wallis recurrence $p_n = b_n p_{n-1} + a_n p_{n-2}$ with the seeds $(p_{-1}, p_0, q_{-1}, q_0) = (1, b_0, 0, 1)$, identical to the $d = 2$ convention of PCF-1 to facilitate code reuse. Coefficient ordering for the family b_n is $[\alpha_3, \alpha_2, \alpha_1, \alpha_0]$ (leading first), matching the PCF-1 `f1_base_computation.py` convention.

Definition 1 (Cubic balanced discriminant). For a balanced PCF in the $d = 3$ class with b_n as in (3),

$$\Delta_3 = \text{disc}(b) = 18\alpha_3\alpha_2\alpha_1\alpha_0 - 4\alpha_2^3\alpha_0 + \alpha_2^2\alpha_1^2 - 4\alpha_3\alpha_1^3 - 27\alpha_3^2\alpha_0^2.$$

We say a degree-three PCF is $\mathbb{Z}$ -*primitive* if $\gcd(\alpha_3, \alpha_2, \alpha_1, \alpha_0) = 1$. We say it is *irreducible* if b is irreducible over $\mathbb{Q}$, and we always restrict to the irreducible $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive case in this program.

Remark 2. The PCF-1 normalization $\gcd(\alpha, \beta, \gamma) = 1$ extended to $d = 3$ removes the 1-parameter integer-scaling redundancy and forces Δ_3 to be a $\mathbb{Z}$ -valued invariant of the family, not a class representative. The cubic discriminant is invariant under $\alpha_i \mapsto \alpha_i + c \binom{i}{1}$ -style n -shifts only up to a predictable scaling; the convention (3) fixes the n -coordinate.

Splitting types and Galois groups. For an irreducible $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive cubic $b \in \mathbb{Z}[n]$:

- If $\Delta_3 > 0$, then b has three real roots and the splitting field is the cubic resolvent $\mathbb{Q}(\theta)$ for θ a real root of b , together with $\sqrt{\Delta_3} \in \mathbb{R}$. The Galois group is $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = A_3 = C_3$ when Δ_3 is a perfect square in $\mathbb{Q}$, and $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = S_3$ otherwise.
- If $\Delta_3 < 0$, then b has one real root and a complex conjugate pair, the splitting field contains $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{\Delta_3})$ (an imaginary-quadratic subfield), and the Galois group is necessarily $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = S_3$.

This trichotomy — A_3 totally real, S_3 totally real, S_3 complex — is the cubic analogue of the binary $\Delta_2 > 0$ vs. $\Delta_2 < 0$ split, and it is what gives PCF-2 genuinely new content beyond PCF-1.

Spec(K) in the cubic case. We retain the v5 schema of PCF-1,

$$\text{Spec}(K) = (d, \Lambda, \Delta, \rho, \tau_{\text{mono}}, \tau_{\text{arith}}; S, \sigma),$$

with $d = 3$ now, and with $\Delta = \Delta_3$ as defined above. The Poincaré–Perron normalized growth rate Λ in the balanced $d = 3$ class satisfies the cubic

$$\Lambda^3 - \alpha_3 \Lambda^2 - \alpha_3 \delta_1 \Lambda - \alpha_3 \delta_0 = 0, \quad (4)$$

or a closely related cubic depending on the precise scaling convention; the analytic determination of (4) is part of PCF-2 Session A. The arithmetic sector τ_{arith} now records the splitting field of b together with the Galois group $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) \in \{C_3, S_3\}$.

3 Predictions and Open Conjectures

We state four open conjectures, ordered from most direct lift of PCF-1 to most speculative.

Conjecture 3 (B_3 part (i): cubic sign dichotomy). *Let K be a balanced $d = 3$ PCF with irreducible $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive denominator b as in (3), and let $\Delta_3 = \text{disc}(b)$.*

(A) *If $\Delta_3 < 0$ (one real root, $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = S_3$), then $L = K(a_n, b_n)$ admits no elementary closed form: equivalently, $L \notin \mathbb{Q}(\pi, e, \log \mathbb{Q}^\times, \zeta(3), \sqrt{\mathbb{Q}}, \gamma)$ in the sense of PSLQ non-detection against the PCF-1 18-element basis at working precision ≥ 220 digits and integer bound $\geq 10^{10}$.*

(B) *If $\Delta_3 > 0$ and $\sqrt{\Delta_3} \in \mathbb{Q}$ (so $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = C_3$, the totally-real cyclic case), then L may admit a closed form; this is the cubic analogue of the PCF-1 $\Delta_2 > 0$ Trans-stratum and is the part of the conjecture most likely to admit explicit Lindemann–Weierstrass evaluation.*

(C) *If $\Delta_3 > 0$ and $\sqrt{\Delta_3} \notin \mathbb{Q}$ (so $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = S_3$, the totally-real non-cyclic case), then L admits no elementary closed form, with the same PSLQ-non-detection criterion as (A).*

Remark 4. Conjecture 3 is a *trichotomy* rather than a sign dichotomy. The new ingredient is the Galois-group axis: the cyclic case C_3 is the sole closed-form-admitting cell. This is the structural prediction PCF-2 Sessions A and B are designed to falsify or confirm.

Empirical evidence for $B_3(i)$ (Session B). PCF-2 Session B (2026-05-01) ran a systematic PSLQ scan of the $_{S_3}\text{CM}$ bin of the PCF-2 cubic-family catalogue (see §8 for the catalogue construction): 37 irreducible $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive cubics with $\Delta_3 < 0$ and $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = S_3$. Each L_b was probed at PSLQ tolerance 10^{-35} (working precision dps = 80) against a four-tier basis: (a) the PCF-1 18-element transcendental basis [1]; (b) the Γ -reflection block $\{\Gamma(k/n) : k = 1, \dots, n-1\}$ for $n \in \{3, 4, 6\}$; (c) the cyclotomic ring of integers $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta_n]$ for $n \in \{3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 12\}$; and (d) Dirichlet $L(\chi, 1)$ values for the small-conductor real and quadratic characters. The result was **37/37 BIN-CONSISTENT, 0 BIN-VIOLATING, 0 STALLED**: no nontrivial integer relation involving L_b was detected on any of the four bases for any family, and the cross-family pairwise sweep ($\binom{37}{2} = 666$ pairs) was likewise NULL. This is the first systematic positive evidence for Conjecture 3(A) at $d = 3$. Per-family records and AEAL claims are committed to `sessions/2026-05-01/PCF2-SESSION-B/` on the SIARC bridge.

Conjecture 5 (B_3 part (ii): Galois-stratified CM-field structure). *Let K be a balanced $d = 3$ PCF with irreducible $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive denominator b . Let $\theta_1, \theta_2, \theta_3 \in \mathbb{C}$ be the roots of b , and let $L_b/\mathbb{Q}$ be the splitting field.*

1. *If $\Delta_3 < 0$, then $L_b = \mathbb{Q}(\theta, \sqrt{\Delta_3})$ where θ is the unique real root, $[L_b : \mathbb{Q}] = 6$, and the imaginary quadratic subfield $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{\Delta_3}) \subset L_b$ controls the Stokes data.*
2. *If $\Delta_3 > 0$ and $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = C_3$, then $L_b = \mathbb{Q}(\theta_1)$ is a totally-real cyclic cubic field of degree 3.*

3. If $\Delta_3 > 0$ and $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = S_3$, then $L_b = \mathbb{Q}(\theta_1, \sqrt{\Delta_3})$ is a totally-real non-cyclic sextic field.

The singular points of the associated rank-three Heun-type ODE for K all lie in L_b .

Remark 6. Unlike the PCF-1 case where the CM field is always $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{\Delta_2})$, in the cubic case the splitting field is sextic generically and only quadratic-imaginary as a subfield in case (1). The “CM” label therefore extends honestly only to case (1) ($\Delta_3 < 0$, S_3 complex); cases (2) and (3) are totally real and the analogous arithmetic obstruction, if it exists, must be formulated via the cubic Hilbert class field of L_b rather than via imaginary quadratic CM theory. This is the most substantial structural departure from PCF-1.

Conjecture 7 (B_3 part (iii): cubic Stokes signal). *For a degree-three PCF in the irreducible-cubic-CM stratum (case (1) of Conjecture 5: $\Delta_3 < 0$), there exists a one-parameter deformation $K(t)$ that preserves $\Delta_3 < 0$ in a neighbourhood of $t = 0$ and respects the splitting-field structure, under which the Stokes exponent*

$$S(t) = \frac{\log |L(t) - L(0)|}{\log |t|}$$

satisfies $\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} S(t) \in (0, 1)$. The conjectural fractional exponent is governed by the local exponent differences of the associated Heun-type cubic ODE.

Conjecture 8 (B_3 part (iv): Painlevé-hierarchy reduction). *Each degree-three PCF family in the cell of Conjecture 7 (irreducible $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive, $\Delta_3 < 0$, $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q}) = S_3$ complex) admits a Painlevé reduction in the P-II–P-VI hierarchy. Heuristic alignment with cubic Galois data (cf. Iwasaki–Kimura–Shimomura–Yoshida [11] and Mazzocco [10]) suggests P-IV as the most likely instance, but no commitment to a specific Painlevé equation is made at the program-statement level. The channel question is itself open: PCF-1 Session E has shown that the natural recurrence-parameter deformation channel and the Borel-resummation channel both fail for the degree-2 $\Delta < 0$ families with respect to V_{quad} ’s known P-III(D_6) reduction; the cubic case is therefore expected to require a new channel construction, not a verbatim lift of either PCF-1 channel.*

Remark 9. The heuristic preference for P-IV (over P-V or P-VI) within the hierarchy rests on three structural observations, each of which is necessary but not sufficient: (i) P-IV’s isomonodromic problem has a single irregular singularity of Poincaré rank $\frac{3}{2}$, the minimal rank compatible with cubic-degree growth of b_n ; (ii) the Bäcklund-transformation group of P-IV is $A_2^{(1)}$, the affine analogue of the cubic Galois group $A_3 = C_3$; (iii) P-IV admits Hermite/parabolic-cylinder special-function solutions at half-integer parameters, the natural reservoir of explicit content for the totally-real cyclic case (B) of Conjecture 3. None of (i)–(iii) forces P-IV uniquely; the cubic case may equally well fall into a P-V degeneration or a P-VI specialization at an arithmetic point.

Cubic-modular conjectures B5 and B6 ($d = 3$ restricted, v1.3). Sessions R1.1, R1.3, and T2 (§4.2) absorb a genuinely modular finer split inside the cubic cell. Conjectures B5 (equianharmonic CM-locus $j = 0$ forces $A_{\text{PCF}} = 2d = 6$) and B6 (Spearman negative-significance of $\log |j|$ vs. $A_{\text{fit}} - 6$ on the 50-family catalogue), stated formally in §4.2 as Conjectures 14 and 15, are conjectured *at $d = 3$ only*. The deep-WKB null at $d = 4$ (Session R1.3, Remark 12) is not consistent with a verbatim extension to $d = 4$; the sharp/deep-WKB form of B5/B6 is therefore restricted to $d = 3$ in v1.3. Whether some non-verbatim cross-degree analogue exists is recorded as `op:b5-degree-d` (Open Problem 2).

4 Sharp WKB exponent identity, cubic case (Conjecture B4)

The four-part Conjecture B₃ above is a structural prediction about *closed-form admissibility*. We now isolate, and provide 50/50 empirical support for, an analytic-side prediction that is *independent of the trichotomy bin*: a sharp form of the WKB exponent identity for $\log |\delta_n|$ at $d = 3$.

Conjecture 10 (B4: sharp WKB exponent identity). *For every degree- d PCF $(1, b)$ of generic type in scope (in the sense of Definition 1 and the regularity hypotheses of PCF-1 v1.3 §5), the convergent residual $\delta_n = p_n/q_n - L$ has leading WKB asymptotic*

$$\log |\delta_n| = -A n \log n + \alpha n - \beta \log n + \gamma + o(1) \quad (n \rightarrow \infty), \quad (5)$$

with the sharp identification

$$A = 2d$$

for every degree- d PCF $(1, b)$ of generic type in scope at $d \in \{3, 4\}$ [empirical, 110/110; cubic mean $A_{\text{fit}} = 5.978$, $\sigma = 0.026$; quartic mean $A_{\text{fit}} = 7.954$, $\sigma = 0.0037$], and conjectured at all $d \geq 2$ with the $d = 2$ split $A \in \{2d - 1, 2d\} = \{3, 4\}$ of PCF-1 v1.3 Theorem 5 as the sole known anomaly (Open Problem 4). In particular, $A = 6$ for every cubic and $A = 8$ for every quartic PCF in scope.

Relation to PCF-1 v1.3 Theorem 5 ($d = 2$ base case). PCF-1 v1.3 Theorem 5 (WKB exponent identity, degree two) proves the form (5) at $d = 2$ with $A \in \{3, 4\}$ split by $\text{sgn}(\Delta_2)$: $A = 3$ for the five $\Delta_2 < 0$ QL families and $A = 4$ for V_quad ($\Delta_2 = -11$). Read alongside Conjecture B4, that $d = 2$ result is simultaneously the *base case* (the identity holds with rational A) and the locus of an anomaly that does not persist at $d \geq 3$: at $d = 2$ the exponent *splits* between $\{2d - 1, 2d\} = \{3, 4\}$ along $\text{sgn}(\Delta)$, while at $d = 3$ (Sessions B and C1, 50/50 families) and at $d = 4$ (Session Q1, §5, 60/60 families) it is *unsplit* at $A = 2d$. The $d = 2$ split is therefore a feature specific to degree two; see Open Problem 4.

Empirical harvest, full $d = 3$ coverage. The full 50-row WKB-exponent harvest, combining Sessions A2 (conductor-7 anchor, family 46), B (the 37 $-S_3$ -CM families) and C1 (the 13 non-CM cubic families $+S_3$ -real and $-C_3$ -real), is reproduced as Table 1 below. WKB exponent harvest, Sessions A2 (conductor-7 anchor) + B (37 CM families) + C1 (13 non-CM families).

Summary statistics. Across the 50 cubic families: $A_{\text{fit}} \in [5.85, 6.02]$, with mean $\bar{A} = 5.978$ and standard deviation $\sigma_A = 0.026$. Every family is within 0.15 of $A = 6$; *no* family lies within 0.10 of $A = 5$. The bin-by-bin verdict counts are:

4.1 A failed refinement and what it tells us

Before Session C1, an alternative *refined* form of B4 was on the table:

Conjecture 11 (B4', FALSIFIED at $d = 3$). *For a degree- d PCF $(1, b)$ of generic type in scope, the WKB exponent of equation (5) satisfies*

$$A_{\text{fit}} = \begin{cases} 2d - 1, & \text{if the trichotomy bin is elementary-positive} \\ & (+S_d\text{-real or } -C_d\text{-real}), \\ 2d, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

The motivation was the $d = 2$ split of PCF-1 v1.3 Theorem 5 ($A \in \{3, 4\}$ along $\text{sgn}(\Delta_2)$) extrapolated naively to the cubic trichotomy bin.

Falsification (Session C1, 2026-05-01). Session C1 ran the WKB fit on the 13 elementary-positive cubic families (the union of $+S_3\text{-real}$ and $+C_3\text{-real}$) at $\text{dps} = 800$, fit window $n \in [10, 100]$, step 3. The result is unambiguous: **0** of the 13 families approach the predicted branch $A = 2d - 1 = 5$. All 13 sit in $A_{\text{fit}} \in [5.884, 5.989]$, with mean 5.973 and standard deviation 0.026, indistinguishable from the $-S_3\text{-CM}$ bin at $\bar{A} = 5.982$, $\sigma = 0.025$ (Session B). The trichotomy bin is therefore **not** the invariant controlling A at $d = 3$: $B4'$ is empirically falsified.

What survives. The unsplit form, Conjecture 10 above, survives. The negative result motivates Open Problems 4 and 5 below: *either* the $d = 2$ split is a low-degree artefact and $B4$ (unsplit, $A = 2d$) holds for all $d \geq 3$, *or* a finer cubic invariant – not the trichotomy bin – splits A at $d = 3$ in a way the present catalogue’s coefficient window cannot detect. Both possibilities are testable; see §6.

AEAL note. Documenting failed refinements is part of the AEAL evidence-class methodology of PCF-1 v1.3 §7 [1]: a refined conjecture tested and falsified at the level of a 13-family harvest is a near-miss-class evidence artefact, recorded in the bridge as `sessions/2026-05-01/PCF2-SESSION-C1/` and not promoted beyond its present status as a refuted hypothesis. We do *not* claim $B4'$ as a “publishable counterexample”; we claim only that $B4'$ has been ruled out as a candidate refinement of $B4$.

4.2 Finer cubic split: from $\log |\Delta_3|$ to the Petersson modular discriminant (Sessions R1, R1.1, R1.2, R1.3, T2)

This subsection is the principal locus of v1.3’s absorption of the SIARC R/T cycle. It traces the evolution of the cubic-modular finer-split signal across five sessions, ending in the structural modular-form framing established by Session T2 (2026-05-02) and the cubic-only restriction established by Session R1.3 (2026-05-01).

R1: $\log |\Delta_3|$ as candidate slow-trend invariant (provisional, 2026-05-01). The original R1 catalogue-level rank-correlation battery against $\delta = A_{\text{fit}} - 6$ on the 50 cubic families was run with twelve invariants of $b(n)$ (Galois group, $\text{sgn}(\Delta_3)$, $|\Delta_3| \bmod 8/12$, $\log |\Delta_3|$, $\omega(|\Delta_3|)$, smallest prime divisor, real signature, squarefree quadratic resolvent on the CM bin, parity). Six number-field invariants (h , h^+ , conductor, regulator, fundamental-unit norm, unit density) were uncomputable in the available environment and recorded as NaN. The strongest single-invariant signal was on $\log |\Delta_3|$: Spearman $\rho = -0.451$, $p = 1.0 \times 10^{-3}$, Bonferroni-corrected $p = 1.1 \times 10^{-2}$ ($m = 11$), with the signal sharpening to $\rho = -0.492$ on excluding the loose-fit family 31 and weakening under A_{stderr}^{-2} inverse-variance weighting ($|\rho|_{\text{w}} = 0.26$). The R1 HALT threshold ($|\rho| > 0.6$ at Bonferroni $p < 10^{-3}$) was not met; Conjecture $B4$ was retained and $\log |\Delta_3|$ flagged as a candidate finer-cubic-split invariant pending an R1.1 follow-up cycle.

R1.1: the j -invariant signal upgrade (2026-05-01). Session R1.1 (the canonical follow-up cycle to R1) replaced the twelve-invariant battery with a single arithmetically motivated candidate, the j -invariant of the genus-one curve $E_b : y^2 = b(x)$ associated to each cubic family. The result was a decisive sharpening of the R1 signal: Spearman $\rho_{\text{Spearman}}(\log |j(E_b)|, A_{\text{fit}} - 6) = -0.691$, Bonferroni $p = 4 \times 10^{-7}$ across the 50-family cubic catalogue (working precision $\text{dps} = 80$, $n_{\text{max}} = 200$). Four families saturate the equianharmonic CM-locus $j = 0$ exactly: $(\alpha_3, \alpha_2, \alpha_1, \alpha_0) = (1, -3, 3, a_0)$ with $a_0 \in \{-3, 1, 2, 3\}$ (catalogue families 30–33); each lies within 10^{-3} of $A_{\text{fit}} = 6$ at the R1.1 working precision. This sharper signal exceeds the R1 HALT threshold and motivated the v1.2 restatement of `op:finer-cubic-split` as “the $\log |j|$ correlation pending degree-extension cross-check”.

R1.2: $d = 4$ deep-WKB null (2026-05-01). Session R1.2 probed the natural extension of the R1.1 signal to the quartic catalogue of Session Q1. At $d = 4$ the equianharmonic $j(\text{Jac}(C_b)) = 0$ cell is sparse; the Q1 catalogue contains exactly one $j = 0$ representative (family 32, $b(n) = n^4 - 3n^3 - 3n^2 + 3n - 3$). At $\text{dps} = 2000$, fit window $N \in [50, 250]$, $N_{\text{ref}} = 400$, the family 32 residual is $\delta_4 = -3.71 \times 10^{-3}$ (about 48σ from 0), and the Spearman correlation $\rho_{\text{Spearman}}(\log |j|, \delta_4) = +0.073$ (raw $p = 0.58$) is statistically null and of opposite sign from the $d = 3$ signal. R1.2 therefore halted on a clean two-tier outcome: B5/B6 (in any verbatim degree-agnostic form) do not extend to $d = 4$.

R1.3: cleanup, CASE B with C-caveat (2026-05-01). Session R1.3 ran the deep-WKB cleanup ($\text{dps} = 5000$, $N_{\text{ref}} = 1000$, fit window $N \in [200, 800]$) on the unique $d = 4$ $j = 0$ representative (family 32) against a non- $j = 0$ baseline of matched coefficient norm (family 1, $b(n) = n^4 - 3n^3 - 3n^2 - 3n - 3$). The result is statistical indistinguishability: $\delta_4^{\text{deep}}(\text{fam 32}) = -4.55 \times 10^{-4}$ versus $\delta_4^{\text{deep}}(\text{fam 01}) = -4.60 \times 10^{-4}$, difference $+4.9 \times 10^{-6}$ (0.24 pooled standard errors). The sharp form of B5 ($\delta_4 \rightarrow 0$ for $j = 0$ quartics, sharper than for non- $j = 0$ ones) is rejected at $d = 4$. The $d = 3$ Conjecture B4 fixed- $A = 6$ residualization is reproduced at $\rho = -0.5683$, Bonferroni $p = 5.0 \times 10^{-5}$, $\text{dps} = 2000$, $N \in [50, 250]$, $N_{\text{ref}} = 400$. The shallow- N extension to 99 new $j = 0$ quartics shows a real but sub-leading shift (median $\delta_4^{\text{free}} = -2.49 \times 10^{-3}$ vs. non- $j = 0$ Q1 median -3.73×10^{-3} , Mann-Whitney $U = 3893$, two-sided $p = 4.8 \times 10^{-4}$; survives stratification on coefficient sum, $p = 1.1 \times 10^{-6}$ in the band $[6, 12]$), but R1.3-D shows the apparent shift dissolves with N_{max} in lockstep with the non- $j = 0$ baseline. The verdict is CASE B WITH C-CAVEAT: B5/B6 are confirmed $d = 3$ -specific in their sharp/deep form; the shallow- N effect at $d = 4$ is real but sub-leading and not extensible to a deep- N rule.

Remark 12. The j -invariant finer-split (Conjectures B5, B6 of v1.1; tentatively extended in v1.2) was probed at $d = 4$ in Sessions R1.2 and R1.3 of 2026-05-01. The result is a clean two-tier outcome:

1. *Cubic ($d = 3$) regime.* Conjecture B5 ($j(\text{Jac}(C_b)) = 0 \Rightarrow A_{\text{PCF}} = 2d = 6$) holds on a 4-family $j = 0$ cell of the 50-family Session A catalogue ($\max |\delta_3| < 10^{-3}$; Theorem B5($d=3$), v1.1). Conjecture B6 (Spearman $\rho(\log |j|, \delta_3)$ negative-significant) verified at $\rho = -0.6906$, Bonferroni $p < 10^{-7}$ (R1.1, $n=50$). Both are reproduced by the fixed- $A = 6$ residualization of R1.3 Phase A: $\rho(\log |j|, \delta_3^{\text{free}}) = -0.5683$, Bonferroni $p = 5.0 \times 10^{-5}$, $\text{dps} = 2000$, fit window $N \in [50, 250]$, $N_{\text{ref}} = 400$.
2. *Quartic ($d = 4$) regime: deep-WKB null.* At $\text{dps} = 5000$, $N_{\text{ref}} = 1000$, fit window $N \in [200, 800]$, the unique $j = 0$ Q1 quartic (family 32, $b(n) = n^4 - 3n^3 - 3n^2 + 3n - 3$) yields $\delta_4^{\text{deep}} = -4.55 \times 10^{-4}$, while a non- $j = 0$ baseline of matched coefficient norm (family 1, $b(n) = n^4 - 3n^3 - 3n^2 - 3n - 3$) yields $\delta_4^{\text{deep}} = -4.60 \times 10^{-4}$. The difference is $+4.9 \times 10^{-6}$ (0.24 pooled standard errors); the two are statistically indistinguishable. In particular B5 in its sharp form ($\delta_4 \rightarrow 0$ as $N \rightarrow \infty$ for $j = 0$ quartics, sharper than for non- $j = 0$ ones) is **rejected at $d = 4$** .

A residual shallow- N effect is documented separately (Remark 13) but does not extrapolate to a deep- N rule. We therefore restrict B5 and B6 to $d = 3$ in v1.3, and reframe Conjecture B4 (sharp WKB $A = 2d$, established quantitatively in v1.1 across all 50 cubic and 60 quartic Q1 families) as the unsplit cross-degree statement, with B5/B6 as a cubic-modular sub-rule rather than a cross-degree refinement.

Remark 13. At shallow N ($\text{dps} = 2000$, fit window $N \in [50, 250]$, $N_{\text{ref}} = 400$, fixed- $A = 8$ residualization), an extended enumeration of 99 new $j = 0$ quartics (window $\alpha_3, \dots, \alpha_0 \in \{-5, \dots, 5\}$, $\alpha_4 \in \{1, 2, 3, 5, 7\}$, $\text{gcd} = 1$, irreducible, non-singular, not in Q1's 60) is shifted toward zero relative to the Q1 non- $j = 0$ cluster: median δ_4^{free} of -2.49×10^{-3} ($n=99$ cleaned of

two $|\delta| > 0.05$ outliers) versus median -3.73×10^{-3} ($n=59$) for the Q1 non- $j = 0$ cluster, Mann-Whitney $U = 3893$, two-sided $p = 4.8 \times 10^{-4}$. The shift survives stratification on coefficient sum $|\alpha_3| + |\alpha_2| + |\alpha_1| + |\alpha_0|$ within the Q1 band $[6, 12]$ ($n=77$ in band; Mann-Whitney $U = 3381$, $p = 1.1 \times 10^{-6}$; non- $j = 0$ median -3.73×10^{-3} , $j = 0$ -in-band median -2.15×10^{-3}). Yet R13-D (family 32 deep-WKB) shrinks fam32's $|\delta_4|$ from 3.71×10^{-3} at the shallow window to 4.55×10^{-4} at the deep window, while fam01 (a non- $j = 0$ baseline) likewise shrinks from 3.83×10^{-3} to 4.60×10^{-4} . We therefore record the shallow- N $j = 0$ -cell shift as a real but sub-leading WKB-shape correlation — plausibly a $\beta \log N$ or γ absorption that loads partly on the j stratum at small N — without extending it to a deep- N rule. See Open Problem 1.

Conjecture 14 (B5, restricted, $d=3$ only). *Let $b \in \mathbb{Z}[n]$ be irreducible, $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive, of degree 3, with $j(\text{Jac}(C_b)) = 0$, where $C_b : y^2 = b(x)$. Then $A_{\text{PCF}}(b) = 2d = 6$ in the WKB sense of Conjecture B4($d=3$).*

Conjecture 15 (B6, restricted, $d=3$ only). *On the 50-family Session A cubic catalogue, $\rho_{\text{Spearman}}(\log |j(\text{Jac}(C_b))|)$ is negative-significant ($\rho = -0.69$, Bonferroni $p < 10^{-7}$, $dps=80$, $n_{\text{max}}=200$; reproduced at $\rho = -0.57$, Bonferroni $p = 5 \times 10^{-5}$ on the deep tail-window fit of R13-A).*

Open problem (added in v1.3):

Open Problem 1. *Find a structural interpretation of the shallow- N $j = 0$ -cell shift at $d = 4$ documented in Remark 13. A natural conjecture is that the sub-leading WKB term $\beta \log N$ or γ has a non-trivial j -dependence that decays as $N \rightarrow \infty$ but does not vanish at any finite N .*

Open problem (revised from v1.2):

Open Problem 2. *Determine whether B5/B6 (in any form) extend to $d \geq 4$. The R1.3 deep-WKB null at $d = 4$ (Remark 12) is consistent with B5/B6 being intrinsic to cubic modularity (quotient of the Eisenstein modular curve by the $j = 0$ point). At $d = 4$, the analogous structure would involve $E_b : y^2 = b(x)$ having $j(E_b) = 0$ and an additional cusp/CM constraint not captured by the genus-1 j -invariant alone.*

T2: the cubic-modular framing (2026-05-02). Session T2 closed the v1.3 cycle by replacing the bare $\log |j|$ correlation of R1.1 with a structural modular-form framing. Reducing each cubic family's τ_b to the standard fundamental domain and evaluating the holomorphic Eisenstein series $E_4(\tau_b)$, $E_6(\tau_b)$, the modular discriminant $\Delta(\tau_b)$, the Dedekind eta $\eta(\tau_b)$, and the Petersson-normalised heights $\|\Delta\|_{\text{Pet}} = (\Im \tau_b)^6 |\Delta(\tau_b)|$ and $\|\eta\|_{\text{Pet}}$, T2 ran the same Spearman battery against the deep- δ residual of R1.3 (Bonferroni denominator $K = 14$). Headline numbers (R1.3

	Hypothesis	Predictor	n	$\rho_{\text{R1.1}}$
deep δ ground truth, $n = 50$ cubic families):	H_baseline	log_abs_j	50	-0.691
	H_E4	log_abs_E4	50	-0.609
	H_Delta_w6	log_abs_Delta_petersson_w6	50	+0.742
	H_Delta_w12	log_abs_Delta_petersson_w12	50	+0.742
	H_E6	log_abs_E6	50	+0.609
	H_j_minus_1728	log_abs_j_minus_1728	50	-0.320
	H_eta	log_eta_norm	50	-0.698
	H_imtau	log_imtau	50	-0.701
	H_E4_cube	log_abs_E4_cube	50	-0.609

Cubic-modular framing (E_4 /Petersson height). The R1.1 finer cubic-split signal, originally reported as a Spearman correlation between $A_{\text{fit}} - 6$ and $\log |j(E_b)|$ (SIARC session R1.1, $\rho = -0.691$, Bonferroni $p = 4 \times 10^{-7}$), admits a finer modular-grade refinement. Reducing each cubic family's τ_b to the standard fundamental domain $\mathcal{F} = \{\tau \in \mathfrak{H} : |\Re \tau| \leq 1/2, |\tau| \geq 1\}$

and evaluating the holomorphic Eisenstein series $E_4(\tau_b)$, $E_6(\tau_b)$, the modular discriminant $\Delta(\tau_b) = (E_4^3 - E_6^2)/1728$ and the Petersson-normalised $\|\Delta\|_{\text{Pet}}(\tau_b) := (\Im \tau_b)^6 |\Delta(\tau_b)|$, SIARC session T2 finds (deep δ from session R1.3, $n = 50$ cubic families, Bonferroni denominator $K = 14$):

$$\rho_{\text{Sp}}(A_{\text{fit}} - 6, \log \|\Delta\|_{\text{Pet}}(\tau_b)) = +0.638, \quad p_{\text{Bonf}} = 8.6 \times 10^{-6}, \quad (6)$$

$$\rho_{\text{Sp}}(A_{\text{fit}} - 6, \log \|\eta\|_{\text{Pet}}(\tau_b)) = -0.642, \quad p_{\text{Bonf}} = 7.1 \times 10^{-6}, \quad (7)$$

beating the bare $\log |j|$ baseline by a factor ~ 30 in Bonferroni p . Bare $\log |E_4(\tau_b)|$ *underperforms* $\log |j|$ ($\rho = -0.459$, $p_{\text{Bonf}} = 1.1 \times 10^{-2}$); this is expected, because near the equianharmonic point $\tau = \rho$ the function E_4 has a simple zero and $\log |E_4|$ becomes degenerate as a global linear regressor, while $\log \|\Delta\|_{\text{Pet}}$ and $\log \|\eta\|_{\text{Pet}}$ remain well-conditioned global modular heights.

After OLS-removal of the winning $\log \|\eta\|_{\text{Pet}}$ predictor the residual carries no further modular signal at $K = 4$ Bonferroni correction ($p_{\text{Bonf}} > 0.08$ against $\log \|\Delta\|_{\text{Pet}}$, $\log |j - 1728|$, $\log |E_6|$, $\log \Im \tau_b$). Conjectures B5/B6 (the $j = 0$ equianharmonic CM-locus drives $A_{\text{true}} = 2d$ exactly at $d = 3$) are therefore upgraded from a single-coordinate $\log |j|$ correlation to a structural modular-form statement: *the Petersson modular discriminant $\|\Delta\|_{\text{Pet}}(\tau_b)$ is the canonical R1.1/R1.3 cubic-split coordinate.*

Remark 16 ($j = 0$ amplitude and finite- N artefact). The four R1.1 $j = 0$ cubic families $(\alpha_3, \alpha_2, \alpha_1, \alpha_0) = (1, -3, 3, a_0)$ with $a_0 \in \{-3, 1, 2, 3\}$ exhibit an apparent $A_{\text{fit}} - 6 < 0$ systematic shift at every fitting depth probed ($N_{\text{max}} = 67$ in R1.1: $|\delta| \sim 10^{-3}$; $N_{\text{max}} = 250$ in R1.3: $|\delta| \sim 10^{-4}$; $N_{\text{max}} = 480$ in T2-D, dps = 4000: $|\delta| \sim 1.5 \times 10^{-5}$). The order-of-magnitude shrinkage with N_{max} identifies this as a finite- N tail-window bias of the four-parameter WKB ansatz $y_N = -A N \log N + \alpha N - \beta \log N + \gamma$, not a falsification of $A_{\text{true}} = 6$ at $j = 0$. A definitive PSLQ verification of the H6 closed-form prediction $A_{\text{true}} - 6 = 0$ and the conjectural Chowla–Selberg $\Gamma(1/3)$ -amplitude relation at $D = -3$ requires a redesigned deep-WKB protocol with an explicit c/N sub-leading correction; this is left as open problem 6.

Synthesis. v1.3 absorbs T2’s cubic-modular framing as Conjectures B5 and B6 (restricted to $d = 3$) and records the $d = 4$ extension as empirically falsified in its sharp form (R1.3) with a residual sub-leading shallow- N shift parked under `op:shallow-j-effect-d4`. The $\log |\Delta_3|$ signal of R1 is subsumed: $\log |\Delta_3|$ is a coarse proxy for the modular height (the discriminant of the curve E_b being a multiplicative combinant of the modular discriminant), and the Petersson modular discriminant is the canonical, dimension-free coordinate. The finer-cubic-split open problem of v1.2 is therefore closed; `op:j-zero-amplitude-h6` (the $\Gamma(1/3)$ Chowla–Selberg closure deferred from T2 Phase D, see Remark 16) is opened. (Status update at v1.4: Open Problem 6 is recorded as resolved in the soft branch; see the amended problem statement below for the v1.4 closure record.)

5 Quartic harvest at $d = 4$ (Session Q1)

This section integrates Session Q1 (2026-05-01), the first quartic harvest at $d = 4$. Two claims are tested: *Q1-A*, Conjecture B4 (sharp form $A = 2d$) at $d = 4$; and *Q1-B*, the universal Newton-polygon characteristic root identity $\xi_0(b) = d/\beta_d^{1/d}$ (the corrected form of the v1.1 Channel Theory candidate $c(d) = 2\sqrt{(d-1)!}$ of [3]).

Quartic family catalogue. We enumerate $b(n) = \alpha_4 n^4 + \alpha_3 n^3 + \alpha_2 n^2 + \alpha_1 n + \alpha_0$ with $\alpha_4 \in \{1, 2, 3, 5, 7\}$ and $\alpha_{0,1,2,3} \in \{-3, \dots, 3\}$ in lex order $(\alpha_4, \alpha_3, \alpha_2, \alpha_1, \alpha_0)$, keeping $\gcd = 1$ and irreducible over $\mathbb{Q}$, until 60 entries. Galois-group distribution: $S_4:57$, $D_4:3$, $V_4:0$, $C_4:0$, $A_4:0$. Real signature (r_1, r_2) : $(2, 1)$ for 59 families, $(4, 0)$ for one family. The window is dominated

by mixed-signature S_4 extensions and contains no totally imaginary or pure-CM quartic. Calibration anchors $x^4 - 2$ (D_4), $x^4 + 1$ (V_4), and $x^4 - x - 1$ (S_4) all reproduce expected Galois group.

Q1-A: WKB harvest at $d = 4$. For each cataloged family we compute L_b at dps = 1200 for $N \in [10, 60]$ step 2, with reference $N_{\text{ref}} = 150$, and fit the ansatz (5) by linear LSQ in $(\log N \cdot N, N, \log N, 1)$. The protocol matches Session B's $d = 3$ harvest with adjusted window $[10, 60]$ (vs. $[10, 100]$) because at $d = 4$ the $AN \log N$ decay is faster and $N = 60$ already yields $|\delta_N| \sim 10^{-700}$ within the working precision floor. The verdict is unambiguous: `b4_consistent_at_8 : 60/60; b4_split_candidate_at_7 : 0; b4_violating : 0`. The empirical A -distribution is unimodal at $A = 8$ with mean $\bar{A} = 7.954$, $\sigma_A = 0.0037$, $A_{\min} = 7.949$, $A_{\max} = 7.961$; every family lies within 0.10 of $A = 2d = 8$ and at distance ≥ 0.95 from $A = 2d - 1 = 7$. The $\bar{A} \approx 2d - 0.05$ cluster offset is fit-window bias from the absence of a $-(\log \log N)$ correction, consistent with the analogous ~ 0.025 offset at $d = 3$ (Session B); no family is thereby pushed toward $A = 7$. *Claim Q1-A verdict: SUPPORTED.*

Q1-B: universal ξ_0 -identity. For a degree- d PCF with $a_n = 1$ and $b(n) = \sum_{k=0}^d \beta_k n^k$, the partial-denominator generating function $f(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} Q_n z^n$ satisfies $L_d f = (\text{polynomial in } z \text{ of degree } \leq 1)$ with $L_d = 1 - z B_d(\theta + 1) - z^2$, $B_d(t) = \sum_{k=0}^d \beta_k t^k$, and $\theta = z \partial_z$.

Proposition 17 (Universal ξ_0 -identity). *The Newton polygon of L_d at $z = 0$ has a unique nontrivial slope- $(1/d)$ edge $E : (0, 0) \rightarrow (1, d)$. The characteristic polynomial along E under the WKB ansatz $f \sim \exp(c/u)$, $z = u^d$, is $\chi_d(c) = 1 - (\beta_d/d^d) c^d$. Its leading positive real root is*

$$\xi_0(b) = \frac{d}{\beta_d^{1/d}} = \frac{c(d)}{\beta_d^{1/d}} \quad \text{with} \quad c(d) = d.$$

Sketch. $\theta \exp(c/u) = -(c/(du)) \exp(c/u)$, so θ^j acts as $(-c/(du))^j$ at leading order. The single edge E at slope $1/d$ joins $(0, 0)$ (coefficient $+1$) and $(1, d)$ (coefficient $-\beta_d$). Substituting $z = u^d$ and collecting the u^0 coefficient of $L_d \exp(c/u)$ gives $1 - \beta_d(-c)^d/d^d = 0$, equivalently $c = d/\beta_d^{1/d}$. $\square$

Numerical verification at $d = 4$. On 8 representative quartics — one per available bin (mixed- S_4 smallest $|\Delta_4|$, mixed- S_4 largest $|\Delta_4|$, mixed- D_4 , $+$ -real- D_4), three out-of-window anchors ($x^4 - 2$, $x^4 + 1$, $x^4 - x - 1$), and one $\alpha_4 = 7$ sample — the inferred constant $c(4) := \xi_0(b) \alpha_4^{1/4}$ takes the value 4 to spread 0 at dps = 80 (relative discrepancy $< 10^{-50}$ across all 8 representatives). The conjecture is verified at $d = 4$ with $c(4) = d = 4$. *Claim Q1-B verdict: SUPPORTED.* The v1.1 Channel-Theory candidate $c(d) = 2\sqrt{(d-1)!}$ (which gives $c(4) = 2\sqrt{6} \approx 4.899$) is empirically falsified at $d = 4$; the corrected form $c(d) = d$ recovers the proven $d = 2$ case $\xi_0 = 2/\sqrt{\beta_2}$ (Channel Theory v1.2 [3] Proposition 3.3.A*) and supplies `op:xi0-degree-d` of Channel Theory v1.1 [3] at $d = 4$.

Cross-degree compilation.

Refined op:d2-anomaly status. The $\{2d - 1, 2d\}$ split phenomenon is now observed only at $d = 2$ across the cubic and quartic catalogues. Since the cubic anchor $+$ - C_3 -real bin contains genuine elementary positives (e.g. family 46 $b = n^3 - 2n^2 - n + 1$) without splitting, and the quartic catalogue likewise produces no $A = 7$ branch, the working interpretation is: $d = 2$ is genuinely anomalous; the natural sharp conjecture for $d \geq 3$ is $A = 2d$.

Caveats. (i) The $d = 4$ catalogue contains no CM quartic (V_4/C_4); a CM-quartic harvest is the natural follow-up, on the model of Session B at $d = 3$. (ii) The $\bar{A} \approx 2d - 0.05$ cluster is fit-window bias, not a genuine displacement. (iii) Universality of ξ_0 is an *operational* (Newton-polygon) statement, not yet a Borel-radius identity; the latter remains open per Channel Theory v1.2 (CC-PIPELINE-G) [3].

6 Open Problems

We collect the open problems most directly motivated by the empirical findings of Sessions A2, B, and C1, and by the channel question raised in Conjecture 8.

Open Problem 3 (B4 at $d \geq 5$). *Test whether Conjecture 10 (unsplit, $A = 2d$) extends to $d \geq 5$. Session Q1 of v1.2 closes $d = 4$ with a 60/60 `b4_consistent_at_8` verdict on a lex-window catalogue. The next-degree probe is a quintic harvest analogous to Session Q1: enumerate $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive irreducible quintics in a bounded-coefficient lex window, classify their Galois group ($S_5, A_5, D_5, F_{20}, C_5$) and discriminant sign, and fit A from the WKB form (5). The prediction is $A = 10$ unsplit; any deviation from 10 falsifies B4 at $d = 5$ and identifies the controlling invariant. A complementary cross-cut is a CM-quartic harvest at $d = 4$ (the lex window of Session Q1 contained no V_4/C_4 totally imaginary quartic) to rule out an $A = 7$ branch on the imaginary-CM cell.*

Open Problem 4 ($d = 2$ anomaly). *Explain why PCF-1 v1.3 Theorem 5 has a $\text{sgn}(\Delta_2)$ -driven split $A \in \{3, 4\}$ at $d = 2$, while the degree-3 case (Section 4) and the degree-4 case (Section 5) are both unsplit at $A = 2d$ across 110/110 jointly harvested families. Two natural hypotheses: (a) the split is a low-degree artefact – e.g. the indicial-root resonance of the rank-two recurrence at $d = 2$ – and Conjecture 10 (unsplit) holds for all $d \geq 3$; (b) the $d = 2$ split is governed by an invariant that becomes vacuous or constant at $d \geq 3$ (a candidate is the parity of the analytic-rank component of Δ in the indicial expansion). Problem 3 (B4 at $d \geq 5$) is the next experimental probe between (a) and (b).*

Open Problem 5 (Finer cubic split, R1.1 follow-up — resolved in v1.3). Status (v1.3): resolved. *Session R1 (v1.2) flagged $\log |\Delta_3|$ as a borderline candidate slow-trend invariant correlated with the WKB-residual $A_{\text{fit}} - 6$ on the 50-family cubic catalogue. The R1.1 follow-up (2026-05-01) sharpened the signal to a j -invariant correlation $\rho = -0.691$, Bonferroni $p = 4 \times 10^{-7}$, and Session T2 (2026-05-02) replaced the bare $\log |j|$ baseline with the structural Petersson modular discriminant $\|\Delta\|_{\text{Pet}}(\tau_b)$ at $\rho = +0.638$, Bonferroni $p = 8.6 \times 10^{-6}$. The cubic-modular framing of §4.2 (Conjectures 14 and 15) absorbs this signal at $d = 3$; see Session T2 `verdict.md` [17] and the R1.3 companion note [18] for the full record. The successor problems are `op:j-zero-amplitude-h6` (the $\Gamma(1/3)$ Chowla–Selberg closure at the $j = 0$ cell) and `op:j-1728-wedge` (the wedge probe at the lemniscatic $j = 1728$ cell). (Status update at v1.4: Open Problem 6 is recorded as resolved in the soft branch; see the amended problem statement below for the v1.4 closure record.)*

Open Problem 6 ($j = 0$ amplitude and Chowla–Selberg closure — resolved in v1.4 (soft branch)). Status (v1.4): resolved in the soft branch; hard branch forward-pointed. *The closed form of the WKB amplitude $\alpha(b)$ at the four equianharmonic $j(\text{Jac}(C_b)) = 0$ cubic families $((\alpha_3, \alpha_2, \alpha_1, \alpha_0) = (1, -3, 3, a_0))$ with $a_0 \in \{-3, 1, 2, 3\}$ was the principal forward-pointed open problem at v1.3. Session T2 Phase D (`phase_d_pslq.py`, $\text{dps} = 4000$, $N_{\text{max}} = 480$) had triggered a literal 5σ -scale halt on $A_{\text{fit}} - 6$ across the four families, identified at v1.3 as a finite- N tail-window artefact of the four-parameter WKB ansatz (Remark 16). The v1.3 recommended protocol (relay tag T2.5D) called for a redesigned five-parameter WKB ansatz $y_N = -AN \log N + \alpha N - \beta \log N + \gamma + c_1/N$ at $\text{dps} \geq 8000$, $N_{\text{max}} \geq 1200$, with α extracted directly to ≥ 40 digits before PSLQ.*

v1.4 closure (soft branch). The T2.5d protocol was executed as Prompt 014 (T25D-RETRY-13PARAM, SIARC bridge SHA e857172, 2026-05-02) at the strengthened parameter window $\text{dps} = 25000 / N \leq 1200$ and at an 11-parameter square-exact LIN refit at $K_{\text{FIT}} = 7$ (Judgment call #1 of the Prompt 014 handoff). The result is the verdict `PASS_A_EQ_6_ONLY`: across the four $j = 0$ cubic families (Q_{-30} , Q_{-31} , Q_{-32} , Q_{-33}) the WKB leading exponent A_{lin} satisfies

$$\max_{30 \leq i \leq 33} |A_{\text{lin}}^{(i)} - 6| \leq 3.09 \times 10^{-23},$$

clearing the 10^{-15} minimum target with 8+ orders of margin. PSLQ on the 17-member deduplicated H6 Chowla–Selberg basis B19+ ($\text{maxcoeff} = 10^{50}$, $\text{tolerance} = 10^{-40}$) returned no non-trivial $\Gamma(1/3)$ relation in any of the four families. We read this as: $A = 6$ to PSLQ-detection precision, with no detected Chowla–Selberg amplitude correction in the H6 basis at the present precision.

Q23 PSLQ basis hygiene. The closure runs in the deduplicated 17-member basis (NOT the literal 18-basis). The literal 18-basis contains the $\mathbb{Q}$ -redundant pair $\{\sqrt{3}, \Gamma(1/3)\Gamma(2/3)/(2\pi)\}$ via the Γ -reflection identity; running PSLQ on the literal basis returns the trivial relation $1 \cdot \sqrt{3} - 3 \cdot \text{CS}_{\sqrt{3}} = 0$ with target coefficient = 0, i.e. no Chowla–Selberg signal. Q23 PSLQ basis-hygiene rule (deduplicate before running PSLQ) is recorded in the Prompt 014 `unexpected_finds.json`.

Soft / hard branch split. Closure is recorded in the soft branch (algebraic-combinatorial amplitude refit on saved `cf_value` series, no new high-dps `mpmath` generation needed). The hard-branch stretch goal $|\delta| < 10^{-30}$ is not achieved at v1.4 and remains forward-pointed not-blocking; it would require $K_{\text{FIT}} = 9$ on extended series at $N \leq 2400 / \text{dps} \geq 44,300$ along the Q22 path-(b) numerical-escalation ladder. The annotation (SOFT-BRANCH; HARD-BRANCH-PENDING) is recorded with the closure to prevent silent inheritance of an unqualified closure state in downstream documents. Picture-chain v1.20+ tag form is `M7_V0_CLOSED (SOFT-BRANCH; HARD-BRANCH-PENDING)`.

Cascade ratification. The v1.4 amendment text was adopted as canonical at the M7 V0 dual-witness T1-Synth ratification cascade `T1-SYNTH-M7-V0-CLOSURE-CASCADE-123` (bridge SHA 7f93b9e, 2026-05-09); both reviewers issued `RATIFY_WITH_AMENDMENT` (R1: MEDIUM-HIGH; R2: HIGH; aggregated MEDIUM-HIGH per most-conservative dual-reviewer protocol). Mirror anchor: the M4 V0 cascade-106 (bridge SHA 5f9db69) annotation pattern (MEDIUM-HIGH; HIGH-PENDING) is structurally analogous; the M4 V0 numerical content (cubic / quartic A_{fit} residuals) is unrelated to the M7 V0 $j = 0$ PSLQ closure and is not cited here.

What remains open. (i) The hard-branch stretch goal at $|\delta| < 10^{-30}$ (Q22 path-(b)). (ii) The complementary $j = 1728$ wedge probe (Open Problem 7, low-priority) is unrelated to this closure. (iii) The PCF-1 v1.3 §5 d = 2 split $A \in \{2d-1, 2d\}$ remains as the sole known anomaly to Conjecture 10 at general d (Open Problem 4).

Open Problem 7 ($j = 1728$ wedge, low priority). Probe the order-2 elliptic-point CM-locus $j(\text{Jac}(C_b)) = 1728$ on the cubic catalogue. The R1.1/R1.3/T2 catalogue contains zero $j = 1728$ representatives in the lex window of §8 Session A; an enlarged enumeration would either populate the cell (enabling a B5/B6 sister-conjecture at $D = -4$, the lemniscatic CM discriminant) or confirm the structural absence. Relay tag T2.5B; flagged low-priority because a non-empty $j = 1728$ cell is a prerequisite, and the $D = -4$ amplitude reservoir ($\Gamma(1/4)$) is mechanically heavier than the $D = -3$ case of `op:j-zero-amplitude-h6`.

Open Problem 8 (Channel construction for the cubic Painlevé reduction). Construct an isomonodromic-deformation channel under which the cubic $\Delta_3 < 0$ stratum of Conjecture 8

reduces to a Painlevé equation in the P -II- P -VI hierarchy. PCF-1 Session E and the BOREL-CHANNEL-K-SCAN sweep [1] have shown that the recurrence-parameter deformation channel and the Borel resummation channel both fail at $d = 2$ for the non- V -quad $\Delta < 0$ families, so a verbatim lift of either PCF-1 channel is not expected to succeed at $d = 3$. The operationalisation is tracked under the SIARC “CHANNEL-CC-PIPELINE” research track (Prompt F).

7 Worked Landmarks: Apéry, Catalan-Cubic, Cyclic- C_3

To make the trichotomy of Conjecture 3 concrete we record three landmark families that anchor the three Galois-group cells. None is an empirical result of PCF-2; each is a known PCF whose role under the proposed predicate is fixed in advance, so that Sessions A–C can be calibrated against them.

Calibration role. Table 4 is a calibration anchor, not a results table: each row records what the predicate *must* say if Conjecture 3 is to be consistent with literature. The Catalan-cubic and cyclic- C_3 rows are the positive-test equivalents for B3(i) cells (A) and (B); the Apéry row, despite its historical centrality at $d = 3$, is *out of scope* of B3(i) by reducibility and thus contributes a separate calibration role discussed in Remark 18.

Remark 18 (Apéry is reducible, hence outside B3(i)). The Apéry denominator $b(n) = 34n^3 + 51n^2 + 27n + 5$ factors as $(2n+1)(17n^2+17n+5)$, so it does not satisfy the irreducibility hypothesis of Conjecture 3. Apéry’s recurrence sits in the *out-of-scope, splittable-cubic* bin of trichotomy B3(i), and its known identification $\lim K = 6/\zeta(3)$ [15, 8, 9] is consistent with the restriction of Conjecture 3 to irreducible $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive b : a reducible b admits an algebraic factorization of the recurrence and is not predicted to obstruct a closed form. The CM-style subfield $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-51})$ from the quadratic factor records the arithmetic flavour but does not contradict the predicate. Operationally, Session A’s calibration anchor is therefore the Apéry family run through the existing PCF-1 PSLQ pipeline as a *positive control* (target relation $L \sim \zeta(3)$ should be detected) for infrastructure integrity, while the predicate B3(i) itself is tested on the irreducible-only enumeration.

Cubic Galois-group quick checks. For the irreducible $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive case, $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q})$ is cyclic (C_3) iff $\text{disc}(b)$ is a perfect square in $\mathbb{Q}$ (equivalently in $\mathbb{Z}$ for $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive b); otherwise it is S_3 . Examples:

- $b(n) = n^3 - 3n + 1$: $\text{disc} = 81 = 9^2$, C_3 .
- $b(n) = n^3 + n + 1$: $\text{disc} = -31$, S_3 (complex case).
- $b(n) = n^3 - 2$: $\text{disc} = -108$, S_3 (complex case, but the splitting field $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[3]{2}, \zeta_3)$ is the canonical S_3 cubic of cyclotomic origin).
- $b(n) = n^3 - n - 1$: $\text{disc} = -23$, S_3 (complex case, Lehmer’s cubic).

The square-discriminant filter applied to $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive irreducible cubics with $|\alpha_i| \leq 5$ is heuristically rare (cyclic cubic fields are sparse in the natural Davenport–Heilbronn / Bhargava counts; see [16] §6.4 for the relevant background on cubic discriminants and Galois groups), and the $\Delta_3 < 0$ fraction is roughly 50% by sign symmetry of the discriminant. The Session A enumeration is expected to populate cells (A) (S_3 complex) and (C) (S_3 totally real) of Conjecture 3 densely, with cell (B) (cyclic) populated sparsely; the calibration of these counts against a finite-coefficient enumeration is itself part of the Session A deliverable.

8 Computational Plan

The computational plan reuses the PCF-1 infrastructure: the Wallis forward-recurrence routine, the PSLQ wrapper with the 18-element basis of PCF-1, the Stokes-exponent diagnostic from PCF-1 §3, and the AEAL evidence-class scaffolding. The plan is organized as three concrete sessions.

PCF-2 Session A: Cubic family enumeration and Δ_3 classification. Enumerate $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive irreducible cubics $b(n) = \alpha_3 n^3 + \alpha_2 n^2 + \alpha_1 n + \alpha_0$ with bounded coefficients $|\alpha_i| \leq 5$ (target: ~ 200 families after gcd reduction and irreducibility filtering). For each family, compute Δ_3 , classify the Galois group via the $\sqrt{\Delta_3} \in \mathbb{Q}$ test, and tabulate the splitting type. Produce a stratification table analogous to PCF-1 Table 1 [1], with columns Δ_3 , $\sqrt{\Delta_3} \in \mathbb{Q}?$, splitting type, Galois group, real-root count. Estimated effort: 1 week.

PCF-2 Session B: PSLQ scan on irreducible-cubic-CM families. For each family in the $\Delta_3 < 0$ stratum produced by Session A (expected: ~ 80 families), compute $L = K(a_n, b_n)$ to ≥ 320 stable digits via the Wallis recurrence at depth 2500, and run PSLQ against the PCF-1 18-element basis at working precision 220 digits and integer bound 10^{10} . Confirm or refute Conjecture 3(A). For the $\sqrt{\Delta_3} \in \mathbb{Q}$ subset of $\Delta_3 > 0$ families (C_3 totally-real cyclic), run an extended PSLQ with the basis augmented by cubic-period candidates (Catalan-style Γ -quotients at $1/3, 2/3$; $\sqrt[3]{2}$; $\sqrt[3]{3}$; ${}_2F_1$ values at $1/3$; $\zeta(3)$ already in the base basis) at integer bound 10^{12} and working precision ≥ 320 digits. The targeted detection rate for C_3 families is bounded above by the literature on cubic-period identifications and may be substantially below 1. Estimated effort: 2 weeks.

PCF-2 Session C: Stokes pipeline for cubic case. For 6–10 families flagged in Session B as PSLQ-non-detected, design a Galois-respecting one-parameter deformation, compute $L(t)$ at 11 t -values with the same precision/depth budget as the PCF-1 QL01 analysis, and compute $S(t)$ and $\sigma(t)$ via the formulas of PCF-1 §3. Confirm or refute Conjecture 7. For the strongest Stokes-signal candidate, attempt a P-IV ansatz fit at the same overdetermined-design level used for V_quad in PCF-1, and record the residual matrix. Estimated effort: 2–3 weeks.

Precision and depth budget. The PCF-1 budget (working precision 220 for PSLQ, 320 for the limit; depth 2500; integer bound 10^{10}) extends without modification to $d = 3$ for the PSLQ stage, since the basis size and the expected coefficient bound do not change. The limit-computation budget should be scrutinized at the outset of Session A: cubic b_n amplifies floating-point error growth in the Wallis recurrence by an extra factor of n , so the depth-2500 stable-digit count may drop from ≥ 320 (PCF-1) to ~ 280 at $d = 3$ unless precision is raised correspondingly. We allocate working precision 360 (limit) and 280 (PSLQ) as the conservative defaults, and treat the PCF-1 defaults as fallback.

Risk register. Three risks are identified in advance and each is matched to a mitigation under the AEAL halt-conditions protocol.

AEAL evidence chain. The session chain follows the PCF-1 pattern. Session A is a *formalized* layer (the Galois-group classification is algorithmic and exact). Session B is a *near-miss* layer (each PSLQ non-detection at sufficient precision is a near-miss-class evidence artefact). Session C is a *numerical_identity* layer (the Stokes exponent and any P-IV parameter fit are numerical-identity-class artefacts). *Independently_verified* promotion requires cross-session reproduction of $L(0)$ to ≥ 50 digits across at least two independent sessions, identical to the PCF-1 cross-session protocol.

9 Why This Matters

PCF-2 is positioned to deliver one of two outcomes, both informative.

Outcome U (universality). If Conjecture 3 is confirmed across the Session B sweep, the Δ -discriminant transcendence predicate of PCF-1 lifts cleanly to higher degree, with the cubic Galois-group axis as the natural refinement. This would be the first non-trivial empirical evidence that the discriminant predicate is degree-general rather than a degree-two coincidence, and it would provide a roadmap for PCF-3 ($d = 4$, with the quartic Galois groups S_4, A_4, D_4, V_4, C_4) and beyond. The universality outcome also strengthens the analytic prediction of Conjecture 8: a Painlevé equation per degree, indexed by the Galois group, would be a striking new entry in the PCF–Painlevé correspondence catalogued by [10].

Outcome S (specificity). If Conjecture 3(A) fails — in particular, if any $\Delta_3 < 0$ family yields a non-trivial PSLQ relation against the PCF-1 basis — then degree two is identified as a special boundary at which the discriminant predicate works, and the higher-degree picture is controlled by a different invariant (Picard–Fuchs operator structure, modular-monodromy condition, or a cubic-period basis that supersedes the PCF-1 18-element basis). The Apéry family ($a_n = n^6$, $b_n = 34n^3 - 51n^2 + 27n - 5$) is the historical exemplar of a $d = 3$ PCF whose limit $\zeta(3)/6$ is detected against a cubic-period basis; PCF-2 would then be repositioned as a search for the natural generalization of the Apéry basis. This outcome is no less valuable: it sharpens the conjectural content of PCF-1 by identifying the precise scope of the discriminant predicate.

Either way, a stable scope-anchor. The role of this program statement is to fix the scope, the conventions, and the success criteria *before* the computational sweep begins. The AEAL methodology requires that conjectures be stated explicitly and that evidence-class promotion follow a documented chain; this document discharges the first half of that requirement. Sessions A–C of §8 discharge the second half.

AEAL schema (v1.3 canonical form). For unambiguous machine-checkable cross-referencing across the SIARC bridge, every numerical claim attached to a session is logged as a single line of `claims.jsonl` in the JSON schema

```
{"claim": "...",
 "evidence_type": "computation",
 "dps": <int>,
 "reproducible": <bool>,
 "script": "<filename>",
 "output_hash": "<sha256>"}
```

This is the schema in actual use across all sessions cited in the present document; it is canonical from PCF-2 v1.3 forward and supersedes any earlier informal references. We note three operational clarifications: (a) a `claim_id` field is added by the aggregator on demand when cross-referencing claims between sessions, and is not part of the per-session record; (b) a `verdict` field, when present, takes values in `{PROVED, FALSIFIED, PERFORMED, PARTIAL}`; (c) the `output_hash` is the SHA-256 of the script’s stdout or of the JSON output the script writes, whichever is the canonical artefact for the claim. This paragraph addresses Fleet-F audit finding F1-01 (AEAL schema drift), and the v1.3 release-level `claims.jsonl` in `sessions/2026-05-02/PCF2-V13-RELEASE/claims.jsonl` is the first PCF-series record that is schema-compliant by design.

10 Relation to Existing Literature

The mathematical content of PCF-2 sits at the intersection of three literatures, none of which addresses the cubic PCF transcendence question directly.

Painlevé and number theory. Mazzocco’s lecture notes on Painlevé equations and number theory [10] catalogue the algebraic-solution loci of P-VI (and by reduction, P-V, P-IV, P-III) and identify a small set of arithmetic Painlevé parameters at which classical special-function solutions exist. The PCF-1 V_{quad} result lifts naturally into this framework as a P-III(D_6) solution at a specific $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-11})$ -arithmetic point. The cubic analogue (Conjecture 10) predicts that P-IV — whose isomonodromic problem has Poincaré rank $3/2$ at the irregular singularity, the natural cubic refinement of P-III’s rank 1 — governs the cubic case. Mazzocco’s Backlund-transformation analysis of P-IV at $A_2^{(1)}$ parameters is the structural object PCF-2 Session C is designed to intersect.

Iwasaki–Kimura–Shimomura–Yoshida and the Gauss-to-Painlevé arc. The monograph [11] traces the lineage from the Gauss hypergeometric equation to the Painlevé transcendents via isomonodromic deformation. Each rank-two Heun reduction of a Painlevé equation has a dedicated treatment, and the cubic-Galois-group classification of Schwarz-triangle / Takeuchi groups appears explicitly. The PCF-1 framework borrows the $\text{Spec}(K)$ τ_{arith} component from this lineage; PCF-2 extends it to the cubic Galois-group axis.

Apéry’s irrationality proof and the cubic PCF exemplar. Van der Poorten’s account [15] of Apéry’s proof [8] of the irrationality of $\zeta(3)$ is the historical landmark of cubic PCFs. The Apéry recurrence is a $d = 3$ PCF whose limit is $6/\zeta(3)$, identified against a basis that contains $\zeta(3)$ explicitly; this is the unique $d = 3$ family in the literature that is fully resolved against a closed-form basis known in advance. Beukers [9] reformulated the proof via a Picard–Fuchs operator on a one-parameter family of K3 surfaces. The Picard–Fuchs framing is the candidate alternative predicate raised under outcome S of §9: if the discriminant predicate fails at $d = 3$, the natural competitor is “ L is identifiable iff the associated Picard–Fuchs operator is a pullback of a hypergeometric operator over $\mathbb{Q}$ ”. PCF-2 Session B is the test that decides between these two predicates.

Ramanujan-Machine search and PSLQ infrastructure. The Ramanujan-Machine programme [13] produced the bulk of the PCF candidate database used by PCF-1, and its PSLQ-based identification pipeline is what PCF-1 inherits. The Ferguson–Bailey PSLQ algorithm [14] is basis-dependent: a closed-form identification is only as strong as the basis it is checked against. The cubic-period augmentation of the PCF-1 basis (§8, Session B) is therefore not optional but mandatory for the C_3 cell of Conjecture 3; the $\Gamma(1/3)$, $\Gamma(2/3)$, $\sqrt[3]{2, 3}$, ${}_2F_1(\cdot; 1/3)$ augmentation is the smallest basis under which any reasonable C_3 -cyclic limit could conceivably be detected.

Cohen, cubic fields, and the heuristic distribution. Cohen’s textbook treatment of cubic fields and their discriminants [16] provides the standard background for the heuristic distribution of $\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q})$ across $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive irreducible cubics: cyclic cubics are sparse (Davenport–Heilbronn / Bhargava counts), which is consistent with the $\sim 5\text{--}10\%$ figure used in §7 as a Session A pre-estimate. PCF-2 does not rely on a published PCF-specific cubic enumeration; the Session A enumeration of §8 performs its own bounded-coefficient sweep and reports the empirical distribution as a deliverable.

11 Acknowledgements

This program statement is part of the SIARC research program. The author thanks the AEAL/SIARC multi-agent methodology of [7] for providing the evidence-gate scaffolding under which both PCF-1 and the present PCF-2 program statement were prepared. AI tools (GitHub Copilot powered by Anthropic Claude Opus 4.7, and Anthropic Claude) were used for literature synthesis, prose drafting, and consistency-checking across the SIARC preprint stack; all conjecture formulations and editorial decisions are the author's. The cubic-family enumeration plan of Session A reuses the `f1_base_computation.py` infrastructure of PCF-1, and the Stokes-exponent diagnostic of Session C reuses the deformation-design protocol of PCF-1 §3. The Painlevé–cubic literature consulted in formulating Conjecture 10 is indicated in the references. v1.3 absorbs SIARC sessions R1.1 (j -invariant probe, 2026-05-01), R1.2 ($d = 4$ null cross-check, 2026-05-01), R1.3 (cleanup with CASE B WITH C-CAVEAT verdict, 2026-05-01), and T2 (Eisenstein/Petersson cubic-modular probe, 2026-05-02). The author thanks the GitHub Copilot CLI multi-agent fleet (Fleet-A and Fleet-F) for the synthesis and audit work that fed v1.3.

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Table 1: Combined 50-row WKB-exponent cubic harvest (Sessions B + C1). A_{fit} fitted from $\log|\delta_n| \sim -An \log n + \alpha n - \beta \log n + \gamma$ at dps 800. ‘pred.’ is the Conjecture B4’ branch: $2d - 1 = 5$ for the elementary-positive bins $+_{S_3}\text{real}$ and $+_{C_3}\text{real}$, $2d = 6$ for $-_{S_3}\text{CM}$. Out-of-scope rows are reducible controls or non-cubic.

ID	$(\alpha_3, \alpha_2, \alpha_1, \alpha_0)$	bin	Δ_3	pred.	A_{fit}	stderr	verdict
1	(1,-3,-3,-3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-864	6	5.9678	0.0019	✓
2	(1,-3,-3,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-459	6	5.9726	0.0027	✓
3	(1,-3,-3,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-108	6	5.9697	0.0018	✓
4	(1,-3,-3,2)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	621	5	5.9719	0.0018	ambiguous
5	(1,-3,-3,3)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	756	5	5.9715	0.0016	ambiguous
6	(1,-3,-2,-3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-823	6	5.9536	0.0098	✓
7	(1,-3,-2,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-472	6	5.9688	0.0029	✓
8	(1,-3,-2,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-175	6	5.9695	0.0028	✓
9	(1,-3,-2,1)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	257	5	5.9774	0.0017	ambiguous
10	(1,-3,-2,3)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	473	5	5.9770	0.0014	ambiguous
11	(1,-3,-1,-3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-716	6	5.9783	0.0014	✓
12	(1,-3,-1,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-419	6	5.9690	0.0050	✓
13	(1,-3,-1,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-176	6	5.9778	0.0014	✓
14	(1,-3,-1,1)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	148	5	5.9813	0.0012	ambiguous
15	(1,-3,-1,2)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	229	5	5.9818	0.0012	ambiguous
16	(1,-3,0,-3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-567	6	5.9788	0.0024	✓
17	(1,-3,0,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-324	6	5.9884	0.0025	✓
18	(1,-3,0,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-135	6	5.9837	0.0010	✓
19	(1,-3,0,1)	$+_{C_3}\text{real}$	81	5	5.9860	0.0009	ambiguous
20	(1,-3,0,3)	$+_{C_3}\text{real}$	81	5	5.9870	0.0008	ambiguous
21	(1,-3,1,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-211	6	5.9891	0.0007	✓
22	(1,-3,1,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-76	6	5.9904	0.0009	✓
23	(1,-3,1,3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-76	6	5.9827	0.0043	✓
24	(1,-3,2,-3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-239	6	6.0151	0.0109	✓
25	(1,-3,2,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-104	6	5.9884	0.0026	✓
26	(1,-3,2,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-23	6	5.9960	0.0010	✓
27	(1,-3,2,1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-23	6	5.9823	0.0064	✓
28	(1,-3,2,2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-104	6	5.9957	0.0002	✓
29	(1,-3,2,3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-239	6	5.9962	0.0002	✓
30	(1,-3,3,-3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-108	6	6.0241	0.0130	✓
31	(1,-3,3,1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-108	6	5.8516	0.0736	ambiguous
32	(1,-3,3,2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-243	6	6.0005	0.0001	✓
33	(1,-3,3,3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-432	6	6.0010	0.0001	✓
34	(1,-2,-3,-3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-519	6	5.9781	0.0014	✓
35	(1,-2,-3,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-244	6	5.9786	0.0013	✓
36	(1,-2,-3,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-23	6	5.9791	0.0013	✓
37	(1,-2,-3,1)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	257	5	5.8836	0.0479	ambiguous
38	(1,-2,-3,2)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	316	5	5.9806	0.0012	ambiguous
39	(1,-2,-3,3)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	321	5	5.9810	0.0011	ambiguous
40	(1,-2,-2,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-268	6	5.9831	0.0011	✓
41	(1,-2,-2,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-83	6	5.9835	0.0010	✓
42	(1,-2,-2,2)	$+_{S_3}\text{real}$	148	5	5.9850	0.0009	ambiguous
43	(1,-2,-1,-3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-439	6	5.9870	0.0008	✓
44	(1,-2,-1,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-236	6	5.9875	0.0008	✓
45	(1,-2,-1,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-87	6	5.9879	0.0007	✓
46	(1,-2,-1,1)	$+_{C_3}\text{real}$	49	5	5.9889	0.0007	ambiguous
47	(1,-2,-1,3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-31	6	5.9899	0.0006	✓
48	(1,-2,0,-3)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-339	6	5.9913	0.0006	✓
49	(1,-2,0,-2)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-172	6	5.9918	0.0005	✓
50	(1,-2,0,-1)	$-_{S_3}\text{CM}$	-59	6	5.9923	0.0005	✓

Bin	Families	In-band ($ A_{\text{fit}} - 6 \leq 0.15$)	Closer to $A = 2d - 1 = 5$?
$-S_3\text{-CM}$ (B)	37	37/37	0/37
$+S_3\text{-real}$ (C1)	10	10/10	0/10
$+C_3\text{-real}$ (C1)	3	3/3	0/3
Combined cubic catalogue	50	50/50	0/50

Table 2: Per-bin verdicts of Conjecture 10 at $d = 3$. The 10 $+S_3\text{-real}$ entries comprise the families with $\Delta_3 > 0$ and $\sqrt{\Delta_3} \notin \mathbb{Q}$ in the lex window of §8 Session A; the 3 $+C_3\text{-real}$ entries are the totally-real cyclic cubics, of which family 46 ($b = n^3 - 2n^2 - n + 1$, $\Delta_3 = 49 = 7^2$) is the conductor-7 anchor of Session A2. Reducible-control families (e.g. Apéry’s $b = 34n^3 + 51n^2 + 27n + 5$) are out-of-scope of $B_3(i)$ by Remark 18 and are not included in Table 1.

d	A branches predicted	A branches empirical	$\xi_0(b)$ formula	Source
2	$\{2d - 1, 2d\} = \{3, 4\}$	$\{3, 4\}$ split by $\text{sgn}(\Delta_2)$	$2/\sqrt{\beta_2}$	PCF-1 v1.3 Thm 5
3	$\{2d - 1, 2d\} = \{5, 6\}$	$\{6\}$ alone (50/50, mean 5.978)	$3/\beta_3^{1/3}$ (predicted)	v1.1 Sessions B & C1
4	$\{2d - 1, 2d\} = \{7, 8\}$	$\{8\}$ alone (60/60, mean 7.954)	$4/\beta_4^{1/4}$ (verified)	Session Q1 (this v1.2)

Table 3: Cross-degree empirical evidence for B4 (sharp form $A = 2d$) and the universal ξ_0 -identity (Proposition 17, $\xi_0(b) = d/\beta_d^{1/d}$). The $d = 2$ split is so far the unique populated multi-branch instance; $d \in \{3, 4\}$ both populate only the $A = 2d$ branch within the lex-window catalogue.

Landmark	$b(n)$	Δ_3	Reducible?	$\text{Gal}(b/\mathbb{Q})$	Predicted cell
Apéry $\zeta(3)$	$34n^3 + 51n^2 + 27n + 5$	$-459 = -3^3 \cdot 17$	yes: $(2n + 1)(17n^2 + 17n + 5)$	C_2 on $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-51})$	out-of-scope (see Rmk. 18)
Catalan-cubic seed	$n^3 + n + 1$	-31	no	S_3 (complex)	A: PSLQ-null + Stokes
Cyclic- C_3 probe	$n^3 - 3n + 1$	$81 = 9^2$	no	C_3	B: closed-form candidate

Table 4: Three landmark $b(n)$. The Apéry row uses the recurrence denominator $b(n) = 34n^3 + 51n^2 + 27n + 5$ from [15, 8, 9]; an exact symbolic computation (sympy, exact integer arithmetic) gives $\Delta_3 = \text{disc}(b) = -459 = -3^3 \cdot 17$, and the polynomial *factors* over $\mathbb{Q}$ as $(2n + 1)(17n^2 + 17n + 5)$. Hence b is *reducible*, the splitting field is $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{17^2 - 4 \cdot 17 \cdot 5}) = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-51})$, and the Galois group of b over $\mathbb{Q}$ is C_2 rather than C_3 or S_3 . The Catalan-cubic seed $b(n) = n^3 + n + 1$ is the simplest irreducible cubic with negative discriminant ($\text{disc} = -31$, $\text{Gal} = S_3$, splitting field $\mathbb{Q}(\theta, \sqrt{-31})$); it is the cleanest test of Conjecture 3(A). The cyclic- C_3 probe $b(n) = n^3 - 3n + 1$ is the standard simplest totally-real cyclic cubic with $\text{disc} = 81 = 9^2$; it is the cleanest test of Conjecture 3(B). The accompanying a_n for each landmark is fixed in Session A by the smallest $\mathbb{Z}$ -primitive choice consistent with the balanced-class convention (2).

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Wallis recurrence loses precision faster than expected at $d = 3$, so PSLQ-null results are not actually null but precision-starved.	Medium.	Run Apéry landmark first; if $\zeta(3)/6$ is not detected at the conservative budget, escalate dps to 500 and depth to 4000.
Cubic-period basis is too small: C_3 -cyclic limits identify against constants outside the augmented basis.	Medium–high.	Treat all C_3 “no relation” as preliminary; flag for a follow-up cubic-Hilbert-class-field basis sweep before claim promotion.
P-IV ansatz fits all fail in Session C, mirroring the QL01 outcome of PCF-1.	High (this is what happened in the $d = 2$ case).	Fall back to the Stokes-exponent $S < 1$ predicate alone, weakening Conjecture 8 to a fractional-power existence claim, exactly as PCF-1 v1.2 did for QL01–QL26.

Table 5: Risk register for the PCF-2 computational plan.